

2020 – A1

1. Consider $H = \{h_{\theta_1} : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \{0, 1\}, h_{\theta_1}(x) = 1_{[x \geq \theta_1]}(x) = 1_{[\theta_1, +\infty)}(x), \theta_1 \in \mathbb{R}\} \cup \{h_{\theta_2}(x) = 1_{[x < \theta_2]}(x) = 1_{(-\infty, \theta_2)}(x), \theta_2 \in \mathbb{R}\}$. Compute $VCdim(H)$.
2. Consider $\mathbb{H}$ to be the class of all centered in origin sphere classifiers in the 3D space. A centered in origin sphere classifier in the 3D space is a classifier h_r that assigns the value 1 to a point if and only if it is inside the sphere with radius $r \geq 1$ and center given by the origin $\mathbf{O}(0, 0, 0)$. Consider the realizability assumption.
 - (a) Show that the class $\mathbb{H}$ can be (ϵ, δ) - PAC learned by giving the algorithm A and determining the sample complexity $m_H(\epsilon, \delta)$ such that the definition of PAC-learnability is satisfied.

(b) Compute $VCdim(H)$

3. Let $H = \{h_\theta : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \{0, 1\}, h_\theta(x) = 1_{[\theta, \theta+1] \cup [\theta+2, +\infty)}(x), \theta \in \mathbb{R}\}$. Compute $VCdim(H)$.
4. An axis aligned square classifier in the plane is a classifier that assigns the value 1 to a point if and only if it is inside a certain square. Formally, given the real numbers $a_1, a_2, r > 0 \in \mathbb{R}$ we define the classifier $h_{(a_1, a_2, r)}$ by

$$h_{(a_1, a_2, r)}(x_1, x_2) = \begin{cases} 1, & \text{if } a_1 \leq x_1 \leq a_1 + r, a_2 \leq x_2 \leq a_2 + r \\ 0, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

The class of all axis aligned squares in the plane is defined as

$$H = \{h_{(a_1, a_2, r)} : \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \{0, 1\} | a_1, a_2, r \in \mathbb{R}, r > 0\}$$

Consider the realizability assumption.

- (b) Find the sample complexity $m_H(\epsilon, \delta)$ in order to show that H is PAC-learnable.
 - (c) Compute $VCdim(H)$.
5. Compute the VC-dimension of the class of convex d-gons(convex polygons with exactly d sides) in the plane. Provide a detailed proof of your result.

2020 – A2

1. Consider $H = \{h_{\theta_1} : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \{0, 1\}, h_{\theta_1}(x) = 1_{[x \geq \theta_1]}(x) = 1_{[\theta_1, +\infty)}(x), \theta_1 \in \mathbb{R}\} \cup \{h_{\theta_2}(x) = 1_{[x < \theta_2]}(x) = 1_{(-\infty, \theta_2)}(x), \theta_2 \in \mathbb{R}\}$
 - a. Compute the shattering coefficient $\tau_H(m)$ of the growth function for $m \geq 0$.
 - b. Compare your result with the general upper bound for the growth functions.
2. Let Σ be a finite alphabet and let $\mathbb{X} = \Sigma^m$ be a sample space of all strings of length m over σ . Let $\mathbb{H}$ be a hypothesis space over $\mathbb{X}$, where $\mathbb{H} = \{h_w : \Sigma^m \rightarrow \{0, 1\}, w \in \Sigma^*, 0 < |w| \leq m, s.t. h_w(x) = 1 \text{ if } w \text{ is a substring of } x\}$.
 - a. Give an upper bound(any upper bound that you can come up with) of the VC-dimension of $\mathbb{H}$ in terms of $|\Sigma|$ and m . In order to find an upper bound
 - b. Give an efficient algorithm for finding a hypothesis h_w consistent with a training set in the realizable case. What is the complexity of your algorithm?
3. Consider the boosting algorithm described(page 4) in the article "[Rapid object detection using a boosted cascade of simple features](#)", P. Viola and M. Jones, CVPR 2001. Consider that the number of positives is equal with the number of negative examples($l=m$).
 - a. Prove that the distribution w_{t+1} obtained at round $t + 1$ based on the algorithm described in the article is the same with the distribution $\mathbf{D}^{(t+1)}$ obtained on the procedure described in lecture 11(slides 10-12).
 - b. Prove that the two final classifiers(the one described in the article and the one described in the lecture) are equivalent.

2021 – A1

Exercise 1

Statement:

Give an example of a finite hypothesis class $\mathcal{H}$ with $VCdim(\mathcal{H}) = 2021$. Justify your choice.

Exercise 2

Statement:

Consider $\mathcal{H}_{balls}$ to be the set of all balls in $\mathbb{R}^2$:

$$\mathcal{H}_{balls} = \{B(x, r), x \in \mathbb{R}^2, r \geq 0\}, \text{ where } B(x, r) = \{y \in \mathbb{R}^2 \mid \|y - x\|_2 \leq r\}$$

As mentioned in the lecture, we can also view $\mathcal{H}_{balls}$ as the set of indicator functions of the balls $B(x, r)$ in the plane: $\mathcal{H}_{balls} = \{h_{x,r} : \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \{0, 1\}, h_{x,r} = \mathbf{1}_{B(x,r)}, x \in \mathbb{R}^2, r > 0\}$.

Can you give an example of a set A in $\mathbb{R}^2$ of size 4 that is shattered by $\mathcal{H}_{balls}$? Give such an example or justify why you cannot find a set A of size 4 shattered by $\mathcal{H}_{balls}$.

Exercise 3

Statement:

Let $\mathcal{X} = \mathbb{R}^2$ and consider $\mathcal{H}_\alpha$ the set of concepts defined by the area inside a right triangle ABC with two catheti AB and AC parallel to the axes (O_x and O_y) and with $AB/AC = \alpha$ (fixed constant > 0). Consider the realizability assumption. Show that the class $\mathcal{H}_\alpha$ can be (ϵ, δ) - PAC learned by giving an algorithm A and determining an upper bound on the sample complexity $m_H(\epsilon, \delta)$ such that the definition of PAC-learnability is satisfied.

Exercise 4

Statement:

Consider $\mathcal{H}$ to be the class of all centered in origin sphere classifiers in the 3D space. A centered in origin sphere classifier in the 3D space is a classifier h_r that assigns value 1 to a point if and only if it is inside the sphere with radius $r > 0$ and center given by the origin $O(0, 0, 0)$. Consider the realizability assumption.

- show that the class $\mathcal{H}$ can be (ϵ, δ) - PAC learned by giving an algorithm A and determining an upper bound on the sample complexity $m_H(\epsilon, \delta)$ such that the definition of PAC-learnability is satisfied.
- compute $VCdim(\mathcal{H})$.

Exercise 5

Statement:

Consider $\mathcal{H} = \{h_\theta : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \{0, 1\} \mid h_\theta(x) = \mathbf{1}_{[\theta, \theta+1] \cup [\theta+2, \infty)}, \theta \in \mathbb{R}\}$. Compute $VCdim(\mathcal{H})$.

2021 – A2

Exercise 1

Statement:

Consider $\mathcal{H} = \mathcal{H}_1 \cup \mathcal{H}_2$ where

$$\mathcal{H}_1 = \{h_{\theta_1} : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \{0, 1\}, h_{\theta_1}(x) = \mathbf{1}_{[x \geq \theta_1]}(x) = \mathbf{1}_{[\theta_1, +\infty)}(x), \theta_1 \in \mathbb{R}\} \text{ and}$$

$$\mathcal{H}_2 = \{h_{\theta_2} : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \{0, 1\}, h_{\theta_2}(x) = \mathbf{1}_{[x < \theta_2]}(x) = \mathbf{1}_{(-\infty, \theta_2)}(x), \theta_2 \in \mathbb{R}\}$$

- Give an efficient ERM algorithm for learning $\mathcal{H}$ and compute its complexity for the realizable case.
- Give an efficient ERM algorithm for learning $\mathcal{H}$ and compute its complexity for the agnostic case.
- Compute the shattering coefficient $\tau_H(m)$ of the growth function for $m \geq 0$ for hypothesis class $\mathcal{H}$.
- Compare your result with the general upper bound for the growth functions and show that $\tau_H(m)$ obtained at previous point c is not equal to the upper bound.
- Does there exist a hypothesis class $\mathcal{H}$ for which $\tau_H(m)$ is equal to the general upper bound (over $\mathbb{R}$ or another domain $\mathcal{X}$)? If your answer is yes please provide an example, if your answer is no please provide a justification.

2021 – A2

Exercise 2

Statement:

Consider a modified version of the AdaBoost algorithm that runs for exactly three rounds as follows:

- the first two rounds run exactly as in AdaBoost (at round 1 we obtain distribution $\mathbf{D}^{(1)}$, weak classifier h_1 with error ϵ_1 , at round 2 we obtain distribution $\mathbf{D}^{(2)}$, weak classifier h_2 with error ϵ_2).
- in the third round we compute for each $i = 1, 2, \dots, m$:

$$D^3(i) = \begin{cases} \frac{D^{(1)}(i)}{Z}, & \text{if } h_1(x_i) \neq h_2(x_i), \\ 0, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

where Z is a normalization factor such that $\mathbf{D}^{(3)}$ is a probability distribution.

- obtain weak classifier h_3 with error ϵ_3 .
- output the final classifier $h_{final}(x) = \text{sign}(h_1(x) + h_2(x) + h_3(x))$.

Assume that at each round $t = 1, 2, 3$ the weak learner returns a weak classifier h_t for which the error ϵ_t satisfies $\epsilon_t \leq 1/2 - \gamma_t$, $\gamma_t > 0$.

- What is the probability that the classifier h_1 (selected at round 1) will be selected again at round 2? Justify your answer.
- Consider $\gamma = \min \{\gamma_1, \gamma_2, \gamma_3\}$. Show that the training error of the final classifier h_{final} is at most $\frac{1}{2} - \frac{3}{2}\gamma + 2\gamma^3$ and show that this is strictly smaller than $\frac{1}{2} - \gamma$.

2021 – A2

Exercise 3

Statement:

Let Σ be a finite alphabet and let $\mathcal{X} = \Sigma^m$ be a sample space of all strings of length m over Σ . Let $\mathcal{H}$ be a hypothesis space over $\mathcal{X}$, where $\mathcal{H} = \{h_w : \Sigma^m \rightarrow \{0, 1\}, w \in \Sigma^*, 0 < |w| \leq m, \text{ s.t. } h_w(x) = 1 \text{ if } w \text{ is a substring of } x\}$.

- Give an upper bound (any upper bound that you can come up) of the VCdimension of $\mathcal{H}$ in terms of $|\Sigma|$ and m .
- Give an efficient algorithm for finding a hypothesis h_w consistent with a training set in the realizable case. What is the complexity of your algorithm?

Example: let $\Sigma = \{a, b, c\}$, $m = 4$ and the training set $S = \{(aabc, 1), (baca, 0), (bcac, 0), (abba, 1)\}$. The output of the algorithm should be h_{ab} .

2022 – A1

1 Exercise 1

1. (0.5 points) Give an example of a finite hypothesis class $\mathcal{H}$ with $\text{VCdim}(\mathcal{H}) = 2022$. Justify your choice.

3 Exercise 2

2. (0.5 points) What is the maximum value of the natural even number n , $n = 2m$, such that there exists a hypothesis class $\mathcal{H}$ with n elements that shatters a set C of $m = \frac{n}{2}$ points? Give an example of such an $\mathcal{H}$ and C . Justify your answer.

5 Exercise 3

3. (0.75 points) Let $\mathcal{X} = \mathbb{R}^2$ and consider $\mathcal{H}$ the set of axis aligned rectangles with the center in origin $O(0, 0)$. Compute the $\text{VCdim}(\mathcal{H})$.

7 Exercise 4

4. (1 point) Let $\mathcal{X} = \mathbb{R}^2$ and consider $\mathcal{H}_\alpha$ the set of concepts defined by the area inside a right triangle ABC with two catheti AB and AC parallel to the axes (Ox and Oy), and with the ratio $AB/AC = \alpha$ (fixed constant > 0). Consider the realizability assumption. Show that the class $\mathcal{H}_\alpha$ is (ϵ, δ) -PAC learnable by giving an algorithm A and determining an upper bound on the sample complexity $m_H(\epsilon, \delta)$ such that the definition of PAC-learnability is satisfied.

9 Exercise 5

5. (1.25 points) Consider $\mathcal{H} = \mathcal{H}_1 \cup \mathcal{H}_2 \cup \mathcal{H}_3$, where:

$$\mathcal{H}_1 = \{h_{\theta_1} : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \{0, 1\} \mid h_{\theta_1}(x) =_{[x \geq \theta_1]} (x) =_{[\theta_1, +\infty)} (x), \theta_1 \in \mathbb{R}\},$$

$$\mathcal{H}_2 = \{h_{\theta_2} : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \{0, 1\} \mid h_{\theta_2}(x) =_{[x < \theta_2]} (x) =_{(-\infty, \theta_2)} (x), \theta_2 \in \mathbb{R}\},$$

$$\mathcal{H}_3 = \{h_{\theta_1, \theta_2} : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \{0, 1\} \mid h_{\theta_1, \theta_2}(x) =_{[\theta_1 \leq x \leq \theta_2]} (x) =_{[\theta_1, \theta_2]} (x), \theta_1, \theta_2 \in \mathbb{R}\}.$$

2022 – A1

11 Exercise 6

6. (1 point) A decision list may be thought of as an ordered sequence of if-then-else statements. The sequence of conditions in the decision list is tested in order, and the answer associated with the first satisfied condition is output.

More formally, a k -decision list over the boolean variables $x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n$ is an ordered sequence $L = \{(c_1, b_1), (c_2, b_2), \dots, (c_l, b_l)\}$ and a bit b , in which each c_i is a conjunction of at most k literals over $x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n$ and each $b_i \in \{0, 1\}$. For any input $a \in \{0, 1\}^n$, the value $L(a)$ is defined to be b_j where j is the smallest index satisfying $c_j(a) = 1$; if no such index exists, then $L(a) = b$. Thus, b is the "default" value in case a falls off the end of the list. We call b_i the bit associated with the condition c_i .

The next figure shows an example of a 2-decision list along with its evaluation on a particular input.

Show that the VC dimension of 1-decision lists over $\{0, 1\}^n$ is lower and upper bounded by linear functions, by showing that there exists $\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta \in \mathbb{R}$ such that:

$$\alpha \cdot n + \beta \leq \text{VCdim}(\mathcal{H}_{1\text{-decision list}}) \leq \gamma \cdot n + \delta$$

Hint: Show that 1-decision lists over $\{0, 1\}^n$ compute linearly separable functions (halfspaces).

2022 – A2

1. **(1.5 points)** Consider $\mathcal{H}$ the class of 3-piece classifiers (signed intervals):

$$\mathcal{H} = \{h_{a,b,s} : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \{-1, 1\} \mid a \leq b, s \in \{-1, 1\}\}, \text{ where } h_{a,b,s}(x) = \begin{cases} s, & x \in [a, b] \\ -s, & x \notin [a, b] \end{cases}$$

- Compute the shattering coefficient $\tau_H(m)$ of the growth function for $m \geq 0$ for hypothesis class $\mathcal{H}$. **(1 point)**
- Compare your result with the general upper bound for the growth functions and show that $\tau_H(m)$ obtained at previous point a is not equal with the upper bound. **(0.25 points)**
- Does there exist a hypothesis class $\mathcal{H}$ for which is equal to the general upper bound (over or another domain $\mathcal{X}$)? If your answer is yes please provide an example, if your answer is no please provide a justification. **(0.25 points)**

2. **(1.5 points)** Consider the concept class C_2 formed by the union of two closed intervals $[a, b] \cup [c, d]$, where $a, b, c, d \in \mathbb{R}, a \leq b \leq c \leq d$. Give an efficient ERM algorithm for learning the concept class C_2 and compute its complexity for each of the following cases:

- realizable case. **(1 point)**
 - agnostic case. **(0.5 point)**
3. **(1j.5 points)** Consider a modified version of the AdaBoost algorithm that runs for exactly three rounds as follows:

- the first two rounds run exactly as in AdaBoost (at round 1 we obtain distribution $\mathbf{D}^{(1)}$, weak classifier h_1 with error ϵ_1 ; at round 2 we obtain distribution $\mathbf{D}^{(2)}$, weak classifier h_2 with error ϵ_2).
- in the third round we compute for each $i = 1, 2, \dots, m$:

$$\mathbf{D}^{(3)}(i) = \begin{cases} \frac{D^{(1)}(i)}{Z}, & \text{if } h_1(x_i) \neq h_2(x_i) \\ 0, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

where Z is a normalization factor such that $\mathbf{D}^{(3)}$ is a probability distribution.

- obtain weak classifier h_3 with error ϵ_3 .

2022 – A2

- output the final classifier $h_{final}(x) = \text{sign}(h_1(x) + h_2(x) + h_3(x))$.

Assume that at each round $t = 1, 2, 3$ the weak learner returns a weak classifier h_t for which the error ϵ_t satisfies $\epsilon_t \leq \frac{1}{2} - \gamma_t, \gamma_t > 0$.

- What is the probability that the classifier h_1 (selected at round 1) will be selected again at round 2? Justify your answer. **(0.75 points)**
 - Consider $\gamma = \min\{\gamma_1, \gamma_2, \gamma_3\}$. Show that the training error of the final classifier h_{final} is at most $\frac{1}{2} - \frac{3}{2}\gamma + \gamma^2$ and show that this is strictly smaller than $\frac{1}{2} - \gamma$. **(0.75 points)**
4. **(1 point)** Consider H_{2DNF}^d the class of 2-term disjunctive normal form formulae consisting of hypothesis of the form $h : \{0, 1\}^d \rightarrow \{0, 1\}$,

$$h(x) = A_1(x) \vee A_2(x)$$

where $A_i(x)$ is a Boolean conjunction of literals H_{conj}^d .

It is known that the class H_{2DNF}^d is not efficient properly learnable but can be learned improperly considering the class H_{2CNF}^d . Give a γ -weak-learner algorithm for learning the class H_{2DNF}^d which is not a stronger PAC learning algorithm for H_{2DNF}^d (like the one considering H_{2CNF}^d). Prove that this algorithm is a γ -weak-learner algorithm for H_{2DNF}^d .

Hint: Find an algorithm that returns $h(x) = 0$ or the disjunction of 2 literals.

2023 – A1

1. (0.75 points) Give examples for:

- a finite hypothesis class $\mathcal{H}$ with $\text{VCdim}(\mathcal{H}) = 2023$. Justify your choice. (0.25 points)
- an infinite hypothesis class $\mathcal{H}$ with $\text{VCdim}(\mathcal{H}) = 2023$. Justify your choice. (0.25 points)
- an infinite hypothesis class $\mathcal{H}$ with $\text{VCdim}(\mathcal{H}) = \infty$. Justify your choice. (0.25 points)

2. (0.75 points) Consider $\mathcal{H}$ to be the following hypothesis class:

$$\mathcal{H} = \{h_a : \mathbb{R}^3 \rightarrow \{0, 1\} \mid h_a(\mathbf{x}) = \mathbb{1}_{\|\mathbf{x}\|_2 \leq a}(\mathbf{x}), \mathbf{x} = (x_1, x_2, x_3) \in \mathbb{R}^3, \|\mathbf{x}\|_2 = \sqrt{x_1^2 + x_2^2 + x_3^2}\}$$

Consider the realizability assumption.

- show that $\mathcal{H}$ can be (ϵ, δ) -PAC learned by giving an algorithm A and determining the sample complexity $m_{\mathcal{H}}(\epsilon, \delta)$ such that the definition of PAC learnability is satisfied. (0.5 points)
- compute $\text{VCdim}(\mathcal{H})$. (0.25 points)

3. (1 point) Compute $\text{VCdim}(\mathcal{H})$ where $\mathcal{H}$ is the following hypothesis class:

$$\mathcal{H} = \{h_{\theta_1, \theta_2} : \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \{0, 1\} \mid h_{\theta_1, \theta_2}(\mathbf{x}) = h_{\theta_1, \theta_2}(x_1, x_2) = \mathbb{1}_{[\theta_1 + x_1 \cdot \sin(\theta_2) + x_2 \cdot \cos(\theta_2) > 0]}, \theta_1, \theta_2 \in \mathbb{R}, \mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^2\}.$$

4. (1.5 points) Consider $\mathcal{H}_\alpha$ to be the class of axis aligned rectangles with fixed aspect-ratio α , where $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$ and $\alpha > 0$:

$$\mathcal{H}_\alpha = \{h_{a,b,c,d} : \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \{0, 1\} \mid h_{a,b,c,d}(\mathbf{x}) = \mathbb{1}_{[a,b] \times [c,d]}(\mathbf{x}), a, b, c, d \in \mathbb{R}, a < b, c < d, \frac{d-c}{b-a} = \alpha\}$$

Consider the realizability assumption.

- give a learning algorithm A that returns a hypothesis h_S from $\mathcal{H}_\alpha$, $h_S = A(S)$ consistent with the training set S (h_S has empirical risk 0 on S). (0.75 points)
 - find the sample complexity $m_{\mathcal{H}_\alpha}(\epsilon, \delta)$ in order to show that $\mathcal{H}_\alpha$ is PAC - learnable. (0.75 points)
5. (1 point) Compute $\text{VCdim}(\mathcal{H})$ where $\mathcal{H}$ is the following hypothesis class:

$$\mathcal{H} = \{h_\theta : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \{0, 1\} \mid h_\theta(x) = \mathbb{1}_{[\theta, \theta+1] \cup [\theta+2, \theta+4] \cup [\theta+6, \theta+9]}(x), \theta \in \mathbb{R}\}.$$

2023 – A2

1. (1.25 points) Consider $\mathcal{H}$ the following hypothesis class :

$$\mathcal{H} = \{h_a : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \{0, 1\} \mid a > 0, a \in \mathbb{R}, \text{ where } h_a(x) = \mathbb{1}_{[-a, a]}(x) = \begin{cases} 1, & x \in [-a, a] \\ 0, & x \notin [-a, a] \end{cases}\}$$

- Compute the growth function $\tau_{\mathcal{H}}(m)$ (also known as shatter coefficient) for $m \geq 0$ for hypothesis class $\mathcal{H}$. (1 point)
- Compare your result from the previous point with the general upper bound given by the Sauer lemma. Are they equal or different? (0.25 points)

2. (1.5 points) Consider the concept class C_a formed by the union of two closed intervals $[a, a+1] \cup [a+2, a+4]$, where $a \in \mathbb{R}$. Give an efficient ERM algorithm for learning the concept class C_a and compute its complexity for each of the following cases:

- realizable case. (1 point)
- agnostic case. (0.5 point)

Solution:

3. (1.25 points) Consider a modified version of the AdaBoost algorithm that runs for exactly three rounds as follows:

- the first two rounds run exactly as in AdaBoost (at round 1 we obtain distribution $\mathbf{D}^{(1)}$, weak classifier h_1 with error ϵ_1 ; at round 2 we obtain distribution $\mathbf{D}^{(2)}$, weak classifier h_2 with error ϵ_2).
- in the third round we compute for each $i = 1, 2, \dots, m$:

$$\mathbf{D}^{(3)}(i) = \begin{cases} \frac{\mathbf{D}^{(1)}(i)}{Z}, & \text{if } h_1(x_i) \neq h_2(x_i) \\ 0, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

where Z is a normalization factor such that $\mathbf{D}^{(3)}$ is a probability distribution.

- obtain weak classifier h_3 with error ϵ_3 .
- output the final classifier $h_{\text{final}}(x) = \text{sign}(h_1(x) + h_2(x) + h_3(x))$.

Assume that at each round $t = 1, 2, 3$ the weak learner returns a weak classifier h_t for which the error ϵ_t satisfies $\epsilon_t \leq \frac{1}{2} - \gamma_t$, $\gamma_t > 0$.

- What is the probability that the classifier h_1 (selected at round 1) will be selected again at round 2? Justify your answer. (0.25 points)
- Consider $\gamma = \min\{\gamma_1, \gamma_2, \gamma_3\}$. Show that the training error of the final classifier h_{final} is at most $\frac{1}{2} - \frac{3}{2}\gamma + 2\gamma^3$ and show that this is strictly smaller than $\frac{1}{2} - \gamma$. (1 point)

2023 – A2

4. (1 point) Consider H_{2DNF}^d the class of 2-term disjunctive normal form formulae consisting of hypothesis of the form $h : \{0, 1\}^d \rightarrow \{0, 1\}$,

$$h(x) = A_1(x) \vee A_2(x)$$

where $A_i(x)$ is a Boolean conjunction of literals H_{conj}^d .

It is known that the class H_{2DNF}^d is not efficient properly learnable but can be learned improperly considering the class H_{2CNF}^d . Give a γ -weak-learner algorithm for learning the class H_{2DNF}^d which is not a strong PAC learning algorithm for H_{2DNF}^d (like the one considering H_{2CNF}^d). Prove that this algorithm is a γ -weak-learner algorithm for H_{2DNF}^d .

Hint: Find an algorithm that returns $h(x) = 0$ or the disjunction of 2 literals.

2024 – A1

Exercise 1. Give examples for:

- a finite hypothesis class $\mathcal{H}$ with $\text{VCdim}(\mathcal{H}) = 2024$. Justify your choice.
- an infinite hypothesis class $\mathcal{H}$ with $\text{VCdim}(\mathcal{H}) = 2024$. Justify your choice.

Exercise 3. Consider $\mathcal{H} = \mathcal{H}_1 \cup \mathcal{H}_2 \cup \mathcal{H}_3$, where:

$$\mathcal{H}_1 = \{h_a : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \{0, 1\} \mid h_a(x) = \mathbf{1}_{[x \geq a]}(x) = \mathbf{1}_{[a, +\infty)}(x), a \in \mathbb{R}\},$$

$$\mathcal{H}_2 = \{h_b : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \{0, 1\} \mid h_b(x) = \mathbf{1}_{[x < b]}(x) = \mathbf{1}_{(-\infty, b)}(x), b \in \mathbb{R}\},$$

$$\mathcal{H}_3 = \{h_{c,d} : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \{0, 1\} \mid h_{c,d}(x) = \mathbf{1}_{[c \leq x \leq d]}(x) = \mathbf{1}_{[c,d]}(x), c, d \in \mathbb{R}\}.$$

Consider the realizability assumption. Compute $\text{VCdim}(\mathcal{H})$.

Exercise 4. Consider $\mathcal{H}$ the class of 3-piece classifiers (signed intervals):

$$\mathcal{H} = \{h_{a,b,s} : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \{-1, 1\} \mid a \leq b, s \in \{-1, 1\}\}, \text{ where } h_{a,b,s}(x) = \begin{cases} s, & x \in [a, b] \\ -s, & x \notin [a, b] \end{cases}$$

- Compute the shattering coefficient $\tau_H(m)$ of the growth function for $m \geq 0$ for hypothesis class $\mathcal{H}$.
- Compare your result with the general upper bound for the growth functions and show that $\tau_H(m)$ obtained at previous point a is not equal with the upper bound.
- Does there exist a hypothesis class $\mathcal{H}$ for which the shattering coefficient $\tau_H(m)$ is equal to the general upper bound (over or another domain $\mathcal{X}$)? If your answer is yes please provide an example, if your answer is no please provide a justification.

Exercise 5. Let $\mathcal{H} = \{h : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \{0, 1\} \mid h_\theta(x) = \mathbf{1}_{[\theta, \theta+1] \cup [\theta+2, \infty)}(x), \theta \in \mathbb{R}\}$. Compute $\text{VCdim}(\mathcal{H})$.

Advanced Machine Learning

Exam, 21st of June 2024

In the following, we denote with $1_A(z)$ the indicator function of the set A . $1_A(x) = \begin{cases} 1, & x \in A \\ 0, & x \notin A \end{cases}$

Exercise 1. (1 point) Give examples of two hypothesis classes $\mathcal{H}_1$ and $\mathcal{H}_2$ such that:

a. $VCdim(\mathcal{H}_1 \cup \mathcal{H}_2) = \max(VCdim(\mathcal{H}_1), VCdim(\mathcal{H}_2))$ (0.5 points)

b. $VCdim(\mathcal{H}_1 \cup \mathcal{H}_2) > \max(VCdim(\mathcal{H}_1), VCdim(\mathcal{H}_2))$ (0.5 points)

Justify your answers.

Exercise 2. (1.5 points) Let $\mathcal{H}_n$, with $n \geq 1$, be the following hypothesis class:

$$\mathcal{H}_n = \{h_a : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \{0, 1\} \mid h_a(\mathbf{x}) = 1_{[0, a]}(\|\mathbf{x}\|_2), a \in \mathbb{R}, a > 0\}, \text{ where}$$

$$\|\mathbf{x}\|_2 = \sqrt{x_1^2 + x_2^2 + \dots + x_n^2}, \mathbf{x} = (x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n)$$

a. Compute the VC-dimension of $\mathcal{H}_n$ for $n \geq 1$. (1 point)

b. Compute the shattering coefficient $\tau_{\mathcal{H}_n}(m)$ of the growth function for $m \geq 0$. (0.5 points)

Exercise 3. (1 point) Consider the concept class C given by the closed intervals $[a, a+1]$, where $a \in \mathbb{R}$. Give an efficient ERM algorithm for learning the concept class C and compute its complexity for each of the following cases:

a. realizable case. (0.5 points)

b. agnostic case. (0.5 points)

Exercise 4. (1.5 points) Let X be an instance space and consider $\mathcal{H} \subseteq \{0, 1\}^X$ to be a hypothesis space with finite VC-dimension. For each $x \in X$, we consider the function $z_x : \mathcal{H} \rightarrow \{0, 1\}$ such that we have $z_x(h) = h(x)$ for each $h \in \mathcal{H}$. Let $Z = \{z_x : \mathcal{H} \rightarrow \{0, 1\}, x \in X\}$. Prove that $VCdim(Z) \leq 2^{VCdim(\mathcal{H})+1}$.

Ex-officio: 0.5 points.

Time: 3 hours.